



INTERNATIONAL SOCIETY OF COMPARATIVE EDUCATION, SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY, NIGERIA

ISCEST NEWS

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ISCEST NEWS

Issue 1

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ISCEST Congratulates Its Former President!

Professor Nedie Patience Akani served as President of ISCEST up until December 2024. She served in this capacity for three successful years. In January 2026, the Nigerian Society for Microbiology (NSM) appointed Professor Akani as the Coordinator of its South-South Zonal Chapter.

Professor Akani, has worked in the field of microbiology for more than four decades. These years of experience, together with the knowledge gained from her years as a lecturer in the Department of Microbiology, Faculty of Science, Rivers State University, have adequately prepared her for the role of NSM Coordinator in its South-South Zonal Chapter.

The entire ISCEST Family extends heartiest congratulations to its former President on her appointment to this important, prominent and respected position in NSM.

See pages 4 & 5 for more on this appointment and the academic profile of Professor Akani.



Professor Nedie Patience Akani



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Bridging the Gap Between Global Standards and Local Realities in Scholarly Publishing

Bridging the Gap Between Global Standards and Local Realities in Scholarly Publishing

By Wulfran Fendzi Mbasso
Mar 23, 2026

Scholarly publishing is often described as a global system built on shared principles: research integrity, editorial transparency, peer review quality, discoverability, and ethical accountability. These principles are essential. They protect trust in science and help ensure that published research can circulate credibly across borders. Yet while the language of scholarly communication is global, the conditions under which journals and authors operate are far from equal.

This is where one of the most important tensions in contemporary publishing emerges: the gap between global standards and local realities.

On paper, standards appear universal. Journals are encouraged, and increasingly expected, to maintain strong ethical policies, use plagiarism detection, ensure metadata quality, provide DOI registration, adopt digital preservation practices, comply with indexing requirements, and now also develop policies for generative AI. These are meaningful advances. They improve consistency and accountability in publishing.

However, the ability to implement such standards depends heavily on context. Many journals, especially university-based and non-commercial journals in developing or resource-constrained environments, operate with very limited financial, technical, and human support. Editors frequently work on a voluntary basis. Editorial offices may not have access to professional manuscript systems, trained copy editors, XML production services, or sustainable digital infrastructures. In these situations, journals may fully believe in international standards yet still struggle to implement them at the same pace or depth as well-resourced publishers.

This difference should not be misunderstood. It is not always a question of commitment to quality. Often, it is a question of capacity.

That distinction is critical because the publishing ecosystem can sometimes confuse a lack of resources with a lack of rigor. A journal may be seen as weak because its workflows are underdeveloped, even though it publishes valuable and socially relevant scholarship. An author may be judged harshly because a manuscript lacks polish, when the real issue is limited mentoring, language barriers, or reduced access to editorial support. In both cases, structural inequality can be mistaken for intellectual inferiority.

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This has serious consequences for the diversity of global knowledge. Some of the most urgent research questions today are deeply local: food systems, rural healthcare, energy access, climate resilience, sanitation, education inequality, infrastructure vulnerability, and community innovation. Journals rooted in local contexts often serve as the first and sometimes only platforms for these discussions.

If scholarly communication values only those outputs that already conform to dominant global models, it risks excluding highly relevant knowledge, even transformative, simply because it comes from different publishing realities.

The solution is not to lower standards. The solution is to apply them with greater fairness, realism, and developmental vision.

Global standards remain necessary. Ethical integrity, transparency, and scientific soundness must not become negotiable. But publishing systems should recognize that institutions and journals do not begin from the same starting point. Expectations should therefore be accompanied by support. Capacity building must become part of the conversation, not an afterthought.



A Prominent Appointment for Professor Akani!



Professor Nedie Akani

The Nigerian Society for Microbiology (NSM) has appointed Professor Nedie Patience Akani of the Rivers State University, Nkpolu, Port Harcourt, as the Coordinator of its South-South Zonal Chapter.

The appointment was contained in a letter dated January 28, 2026, signed by the President of the Society, Professor S. A. Ado. It is for a two-year tenure, renewable for another two years.

Professor Akani, a seasoned microbiologist with over four decades of academic and research experience, will oversee the Society's programmes and activities in the South-South zone, with a focus on strengthening

microbiology research, education and professional collaboration.

Speaking on the appointment, Professor Akani expressed appreciation to the Society for the honour and pledged her commitment to advancing the objectives of the Society in the region.

"I am honoured to serve the Society and contribute to the advancement of microbiology in the South-South region. I look forward to working closely with members, stakeholders and partners to promote microbiological research, education and outreach," she stated.

The future belongs to the competent. Get good, get better, be the best! - Brian Tracy.

Profiling Professor Nedie Akani

Founded in 1972, the Nigerian Society for Microbiology is the umbrella body for microbiologists in Nigeria, with a membership strength of over 5,000. The Society promotes research and innovation in microbiology with applications in health, agriculture, industry and environmental sustainability.

Akani is a Professor of Environmental Microbiology and Public Health and a lecturer in the Department of Microbiology, Faculty of Science, Rivers State University. She holds a B.Sc. in Microbiology from the University of Port Harcourt, an MPhil in Applied Microbiology, and a PhD in Environmental Biology from Rivers State University.



Professor Nedie Akani

She joined the academic staff of Rivers State University in 1991, rose to the rank of Professor in 2022, and served as Head of the Department of Microbiology from 2020 to 2022. She has supervised numerous undergraduate and postgraduate students and has over 100 scholarly publications in reputable journals. Her research interests include Public Health Microbiology, Environmental Microbiology, Emerging Infectious Diseases and Antimicrobial Resistance.

Professor Akani has supervised over 100 undergraduate projects, 13 PhD, 25 MSc, and three PGD students, underscoring her commitment to mentorship and capacity building. She has served as an external examiner to several universities, including the University of Port Harcourt, Niger Delta University and University of Africa, Toru-Orua, and was a Visiting Professor at the Federal University Otuoke between 2024 and 2025.

Her professional recognitions include being a Fellow of the International Society of Comparative Education, Science and Technology (ISCEST), where she served as President from 2021 to 2024. She is also a member of several national and international professional bodies, including the American Society for Microbiology and the Nigerian Society for Microbiology. A seasoned researcher, she has over 100 peer-reviewed publications and has presented papers at numerous local and international conferences. Her research interests span Public Health Microbiology, Environmental Microbiology, Microbial Ecology, Emerging and Re-emerging Infectious Diseases, Antimicrobial Resistance, and Ecotoxicology, with strong interdisciplinary collaborations in Epidemiology and Clinical Medicine.

Beyond academia, Professor Akani is known for her love for singing, reading and faith-based service. She is married to Dr. Alexander Bekweri Akani, and the union is blessed with four children.

Utilization of Azolla and Water Lettuce

Prof. Godwin Isitor, DVM, MS, PhD, FISCEST. Ugo Resorts and Health Farms Ltd., Ekwuoma, Ika North-East LGA, Delta State, Nigeria

Abstract

Aquatic plants represent abundant but underutilized biological resources in tropical freshwater ecosystems. This article examines the potential of Azolla and water lettuce as components of integrated farming systems supporting aquaculture, livestock feeding, and organic fertilizer production. Field observations from pond ecosystems suggest that decomposing Azolla biomass enriches water with nutrients that stimulate vigorous growth of water lettuce, illustrating an efficient natural nutrient cycling process. By harnessing these ecological interactions, farmers can produce fermented feed additives, liquid biofertilizers, and organic compost while reducing reliance on commercial feed and chemical fertilizers.

1. Introduction

Smallholder agriculture in tropical regions faces increasing challenges due to rising costs of commercial feed and chemical fertilizers. At the same time, many aquatic ecosystems naturally produce large quantities of floating plants that are rarely utilized productively.

Azolla is a floating aquatic fern known for its symbiotic relationship with nitrogen-fixing cyanobacteria that convert atmospheric nitrogen into plant-available forms. Because of this property, Azolla has been widely used as a green manure in rice cultivation systems.

Water lettuce is another common floating plant that grows rapidly in nutrient-rich water bodies. Although often regarded as an aquatic weed, it contains useful nutrients and organic biomass that can be utilized for feed and fertilizer production.

2. Observations from Pond Ecosystems

Observations in pond ecosystems show that dense Azolla mats periodically die due to environmental factors such as nutrient depletion or overcrowding. However, prior to death, the plants undergo a remarkable colour transformation of the leaves from typical green to reddish-brown (Fig. 1). When this occurs, the decomposing biomass releases nitrogen and other minerals into the surrounding water.

Water lettuce frequently responds to this nutrient release with rapid growth and expansion, suggesting that decomposing Azolla functions as a natural fertilizer within aquatic ecosystems.

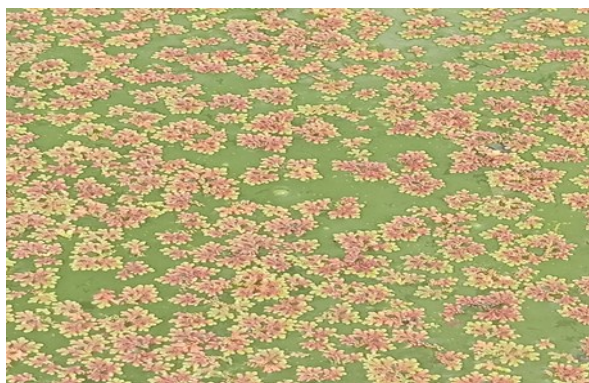
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Fig. 1. Reddish-coloured Azolla plants; representing the first sign of degeneration and decomposition within the pond, prior to formation of the



Fig. 2. Typical greenish and flourishing Water lettuce plant after the death of the Azolla plants with resultant decomposed slurry for-

Crude Protein	20–30%
Nitrogen	3–5%
Phosphorus	0.5–1%
Potassium	2–4%
Minerals	High

Due to its high protein content and mineral composition, Azolla can be incorporated into livestock and aquaculture feeds as a supplementary ingredient.

4. Fermented Aquatic Plant Feed Production

Fermentation is an effective method for improving digestibility and nutritional value of aquatic plant biomass. During fermentation, microorganisms break down plant fibers while producing enzymes and beneficial organic acids.

A mixture of chopped water lettuce, fresh Azolla, maize bran or rice bran, molasses, and spices such as garlic and ginger can be fermented for approximately five to seven days to produce a probiotic feed mash.

Lecturer Collapses, Dies During Lecture at Kogi Polytechnic



Staff and students of Kogi State Polytechnic have been thrown into mourning after the death of a lecturer in the institution's Department of Public Administration, Anslem Ojodomo, who reportedly collapsed while teaching.

The incident was confirmed in a statement issued on Friday

by the Rector, Prof. Salihu Avidime, and signed by the Acting Coordinator of the Directorate of Public Relations, John Onimisi. The rector expressed deep sorrow over the loss, describing it as a personal shock. Avidime recalled that he had met with the late lecturer only hours before the incident, noting that they had exchanged pleasantries and appeared in good spirits. He described Ojodomo as a dedicated academic who demonstrated humility, professionalism, and a strong commitment to excellence throughout his career. "The Polytechnic community is mourning the loss of a promising academic and dependable colleague, who embodied scholarship, service, and character," the rector said, adding that Ojodomo's contributions as Deputy Dean, Students' Services, and lecturer left a lasting impact.

The development comes barely a month after the institution lost another lecturer, Dr Barnabas Akuba, shortly after completing his PhD programme.

Eyewitness accounts from students indicated that Ojodomo collapsed while addressing them during a lecture and was rushed to a nearby hospital, where he was confirmed dead. His sudden death has heightened concern within the academic community, with staff and students expressing anxiety over the loss of two lecturers within a short period.

Ojodomo, who joined the polytechnic in 2021, was described as a committed educator who held Master's degrees from Prince Abubakar Audu University and had recently defended his PhD proposal. He also served on several committees within the institution and was regarded as an inspiring figure among colleagues and students.

The polytechnic community extended its condolences to his family and the people of Igalamela/Odolu, praying for the repose of his soul.

<https://dailypost.ng/2026/03/28/lecturer-collapses-dies-during-lecture-at-kogi-polytechnic/>

Space Technology Key to Tackling Insecurity, says NASRDA D-G

By Ijeoma Olorunfemi

Director-General of the National Space Research and Development Agency (NASRDA), Dr Matthew Adepoju, has stressed the critical role of space technology in strengthening Nigeria's national security architecture. Adepoju made the remarks on Thursday, February 26, 2026, during a courtesy visit to the Minis-



Director-General of the National Space Research and Development Agency (NASRDA), Dr Matthew Adepoju, with the Minister of Defence, retired Gen. Christopher Musa

ter of Defence, retired Gen. Christopher Musa, in Abuja. He said Nigeria's evolving security challenges required sustained investment in advanced technological solutions, as well as stronger inter-agency collaboration. According to him, NASRDA remains the only civilian agency in the country statutorily mandated to develop satellites.

The NASRDA boss highlighted some of the agency's existing capabilities, including Artificial Intelligence-enabled monitoring systems designed to track activities over long distances and function both day and night. He also disclosed that the agency was working toward deploying four new satellites to boost surveillance and earth observation capacity.

Adepoju said the development would significantly enhance Nigeria's ability to monitor its borders and respond swiftly to emerging security threats.

Musa, who described the visit as timely and strategic, said the space agency played a vital role in supporting the ministry's efforts to combat terrorism and strengthen national security operations. Musa noted that closer collaboration with NASRDA would improve operational efficiency and enhance the effectiveness of defence activities. He assured the agency of the ministry's full support in enabling it to achieve its mandate.

<https://www.environewsnigeria.com/space-technology-key-to-tackling-insecurity-says-nasrda-d-g/>

Cont'd from Page 7**5. Organic Fertilizer Production**

Azolla biomass can also be processed into organic fertilizers. Liquid biofertilizer can be produced by fermenting Azolla and water lettuce in water with molasses for approximately ten to fourteen days.

Alternatively, Azolla can be composted with poultry manure and crop residues to produce a nutrient-rich organic soil amendment.

6. Integrated Aquaculture Farming Model

Integrated aquaculture systems combine fish production, aquatic plant cultivation, livestock feeding, and crop production. Fish waste provides nutrients that stimulate the growth of Azolla and other aquatic plants.

These plants are harvested and utilized as feed ingredients or processed into fertilizer products, creating a circular nutrient cycle within the farm.

7. Economic and Environmental Implications

Utilizing aquatic plants as feed and fertilizer can significantly reduce farm production costs while improving environmental sustainability.

8. Conclusion

The integration of Azolla and water lettuce into farming systems provides a sustainable strategy for improving agricultural productivity and resource efficiency in tropical regions.

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SCIENCE AND
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(IST YENAGOA)**

ISCEST Secretariat
Plot 1 Gen.
Andrew Azazi Drive
Off Imgbi Road, Amarata
Yenagoa
Bayelsa State
Nigeria

Phone: +234 (0) 815 762
8802

Email:
instituteofsciandtechyenagoa
@gmail.com

Newsletter Editor:
Dr Gertrude Shotte

ISCEST LOC Researcher
Emesakoru Enifome

Check our website!
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Keep ISCEST's Annual Conference in Mind!

Here's a reminder to keep ISCEST's annual conference in mind. Preparations are on the way to present the conference as a hybrid event. The *Call for Papers*, which will announce the conference theme, venue and date, will be published shortly. As in previous years, the subthemes will be based on education, science and technology. Plan to attend. Plan to participate.



Professor Matthew Wegwu

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It is our honour and sincerest intention

To always show you how grateful we are

By remembering to show appreciation



Gertrude Shotte